



Think College National Coordinating Center WEBINAR TIPS & TAKEAWAYS



Tips from Faculty: Engaging Students with Intellectual Disability Enrolled in College Courses

Shakonda Diggs & Patrick McDermott

This webinar focuses on how faculty support students with intellectual disability enrolled in their college courses. Professors Shakonda Diggs and Patrick McDermott share their experiences supporting students with intellectual disability enrolled in college success and leadership classes. The professors emphasize the importance of having a support system in place to aid students in and outside the classroom. They also discuss how to adjust assignments and assessments to support students' development using academic agreements.

Takeaways

What is an academic agreement? Instructors can use academic agreements to establish coursework and course participation expectations for their students. An academic agreement sets an achievable level of work for the student in the course and for the instructor to base the course grade on. The student and instructor create the academic agreement together by following these steps:

1. The instructor shares an academic agreement template and the course syllabus with the student.
2. The student looks at the learning objectives on the syllabus and then chooses which objectives they want to meet. Program mentors, instructors, and staff can support students in this planning process.
3. Together, the instructor and student meet to review the template. They discuss learning objectives, the activities and assignments from the syllabus that will give the student the chance to meet their negotiated learning objectives, how the instructor can adjust the assignments, and which objectives are non-negotiable. Program staff can help new instructors with this negotiation.
4. The instructor revises the student's academic agreement and sends it back to the student and staff for feedback.
5. Students and program staff give feedback and make any necessary changes. Once the student and instructor finalize the agreement, the instructor, student, and staff can meet regularly to assess the agreement and make additional adjustments as needed.

If you missed this great webinar, you are in luck! We recorded it and you can watch it for FREE right here!



RESOURCES

[Think College Universal Design Learning Module](#)

[Faculty Perspectives on Inclusive Courses](#)

[Universal Design in the College Classroom: Faculty Experience](#)



As a faculty member, it is important to understand you have to go with the flow. If you have a conversation with the student and discover something is not going to work, it is not going to work. Modifications need to be revisited.



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